HDR DATASET NOTE

German Breast Cancer Study Group trial 2 (GBSG-2)

HDR-DE-0001 | version 1.0.0 | 2026-11-02

DOI	Pending, minted at publication
CREATORS	Imad El Badisy
COVERAGE	Germany
PERIOD	1984 to 1989
UNIT	Patient
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0
LANDING PAGE	https://elbadisyimad.com/hdr/datasets/de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial/

Description

Patient records from the GBSG-2 randomised 2x2 trial of hormonal treatment and chemotherapy duration in node-positive breast cancer in Germany: tumour and patient characteristics with recurrence-free survival time.

A classic trial dataset for prognostic modelling in breast cancer.

GOOD FOR

- Prognostic modelling
- Teaching Cox regression

NOT GOOD FOR

- Treatment effects of modern therapies

Origin

ORGANISATION	German Breast Cancer Study Group
PUBLICATION	*Schumacher M et al. (1994). Randomized 2x2 trial evaluating hormonal treatment and the duration of chemotherapy in node-positive breast cancer patients. J Clin Oncol 12: 2086-2093*
COUNTRY	Germany
ADDRESS	https://doi.org/10.1200/JCO.1994.12.10.2086
ACCESSED	2026-11-02
REUSE TERMS	Distributed openly for research in the TH.data R package (GPL-3).
HOW OBTAINED	Taken from the BioBench R package (dataset gbsg2), which took them from TH.data::GBSG2. Complete cases only (686 of 720 patients).

Files

File	Content	Rows	Cols	Size
`gbsg2.csv`	One row per patient	686	10	26 kB
`de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial.xlsx`	All tables in one workbook, with About and Variables sheets			39 kB

SHA-256 checksums of every file are listed in `manifest.csv` on the landing page.

Variables

`gbsg2.csv` One row per patient

Variable	Type	Description

`horTh`	string	Hormonal therapy (yes, no)
`age`	integer	Age (years)
`menostat`	string	Menopausal status (Pre, Post)
`tsize`	integer	Tumour size (mm)
`tgrade`	string	Tumour grade (I, II, III)
`pnodes`	integer	Number of positive lymph nodes
`progrec`	integer	Progesterone receptor (fmol)
`estrec`	integer	Oestrogen receptor (fmol)
`time`	integer	Recurrence-free survival time (days)
`cens`	integer	Event (1 recurrence or death, 0 censored)

Known issues

Read these before analysis.

1. **Demonstration entry.** Taken from the BioBench R package to show how HDR presents a dataset. It has not gone through HDR review and will be removed before launch.
2. **Complete cases only.** 34 patients with missing values were dropped by the source.

How to cite

Imad El Badisy (2026). German Breast Cancer Study Group trial 2 (GBSG-2) (version 1.0.0) [Data set]. HDR: Health Data for Research. https://elbadisyimad.com/hdr/datasets/de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial/

Please also cite the origin: German Breast Cancer Study Group, Schumacher M et al. (1994). Randomized 2x2 trial evaluating hormonal treatment and the duration of chemotherapy in node-positive breast cancer patients. J Clin Oncol 12: 2086-2093.

Versions

Version	Date	Changes
1.0.0	2026-11-02	Demonstration release

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